taking on Pramodak I. By 10.30 p.m., all the other posts were also silenced. The fight put up by the militiamen had been of the highest calibre. Chandni was in the charge of Subedar Sonam Stopdan who had fifty men with him. They fought with everything they had, but, one by one, most of them were killed. Eventually, Stopdan was also fell. The few remaining men then pulled out under cover of darkness. Takkar post was still holding out, but the main Jodha post had been vacated with two radio operators being taken prisoner. Strangely, the Chinese did not occupy the Indian position and withdrew instead. The post commander, Subedar Rigzen Phunchok, along with the remaining three survivors, reoccupied it. They would hold the position till 28 October until they were finally ordered to pull out.

North of the Chip Chap River, the Chinese had crossed the river and positioned a MMG opposite Bhanu post that was manned by 5 Jat's Charlie Company. They started firing at first light on 20 October after they noticed Naik Bare Singh go across the river to relieve himself. The NCO managed to scramble back and organize his men who immediately engaged the enemy. Chinese mortars also joined in and kept up an intermittent barrage through the day. Sepoys Arjun Singh, Badan Singh, Jai Lal and Tale Ram were killed.

The Jats have always been extremely tough nuts to crack—as the Sinkiang Muslim troops were finding out the hard way. However, without ammunition there is little anyone can do and the rest of the men started pulling out to Arni I and Arni II, the two northernmost Indian positions. Naik Bare Singh along with Sepoy Bahadur Singh and Salu Singh stayed back to cover the withdrawal. However, when it was their turn to pull out, the Chinese surrounded them. Bahadur Singh was killed, while the other two were taken prisoner. Shortly thereafter, Salu Singh managed to escape, and he made his way to Arni I. By 6 p.m. on 20 October, Bhanu post had ceased to exist.

Arni I was being commanded by Naik Chand Singh. The terrain combined with the altitude gave the Indians the advantage. The Chinese kept out of small arms range and peppered the post with mortar and MMG bursts through the day. The arrival of a few extra men from Bhanu post further strengthened the resolve of the men to fight. Through the night, the Chinese kept up a steady barrage in which three Indian soldiers were killed. By first light on 21 October, the Chinese had taken up positions on three sides of the post, but the Jats were not ready to give up. Chinese infantry